DEEPSTACK The Buildout · Part 14 · Memo

MARKETS

The Cash Arrives Unevenly

Microsoft, Alphabet, Amazon and Meta spent 96 cents on property and equipment for each dollar of operating cash in the second quarter of 2026, up from 65 cents across 2025, by DeepStack's reading of SEC filings. Microsoft still pays from its own cash. Amazon spent $1.38 per dollar in the first half.

By DeepStack · October 14, 2026 · Markets · 10 min read on the page · deepstack.ltd/stories/the-cash-arrives-unevenly/

THE DEEPSTACK CALL

Split Only Microsoft pays with room to spare

Microsoft pays for its build from its own cash. Alphabet and Meta spend most of theirs; Amazon spends more than its operations bring in.

Conviction Moderate (3/5) · Version 2 · Oct 14, 2026

WHAT TO DO WITH THIS

1. Divide capital spending by operating cash, company by company: in the first half of 2026 Microsoft spent 65.3%, Amazon 137.8%.
2. Hold free cash flow to one ruler: Meta's own measure gave $784 million for the June quarter of 2026; cash less purchases, $1.7 billion.
3. Read the financing section beside the spending line: Alphabet sold $49.6 billion of stock in June 2026, and Meta borrowed $24.9 billion.

WHAT WOULD CHANGE OUR MIND

- Alphabet spends under 80 cents of each operating dollar in the September quarter: its cash is catching up with its build.
- Microsoft's purchases pass 85% of its operating cash in the September quarter: even the strongest cloud stops paying its way.
- The four's purchases top their operating cash for the September quarter or for 2026: the group stops paying, toward the debt side.

THE FULL ARGUMENT

DeepStack's view is that only Microsoft pays for its build with room to spare. In the first half of 2026 it spent 65.3 cents of each operating dollar on property and equipment and kept $35.4 billion. Meta spent 76.6 cents and borrowed $24.9 billion in the second quarter; Alphabet spent 95.0 cents and sold $49.6 billion of stock in June; Amazon spent $1.38 for each dollar its operations brought in. As a group the four still pay, narrowly: the guidance points to more spending in the second half, and the cash runs stronger after June. The single most important reason for caution is the calendar: the September quarter brings in more cash than the June quarter, so one quarter can understate the strain. The view changes if Alphabet spends under 80 cents of each operating dollar in the September quarter, or if Microsoft spends more than 85 cents. The first answer arrives on October 28.

CALL HISTORY

Version	Date	Stance	Conviction	Reason	By
v2	Oct 14, 2026	Only Microsoft pays with room to spare	Moderate (3/5)	Side named by the owner.	Marco Cauduro
v1	Oct 14, 2026	Only Microsoft pays with room to spare	Moderate (3/5)	First call, with the story.	DeepStack

BY THE NUMBERS

96.1%

Capital spending per dollar of operating cash, Microsoft, Alphabet, Amazon and Meta, second quarter of 2026

SEC XBRL filings, read Oct 12, 2026; DeepStack calculation; 64.8% across 2025

137.8%

Amazon's purchases of property and equipment against its operating cash, first half of 2026

SEC XBRL filings, read Oct 12, 2026; DeepStack calculation; 94.5% across 2025

$35.4B

Microsoft's operating cash left after purchases of property and equipment, first half of 2026

SEC XBRL filings, read Oct 12, 2026; DeepStack calculation; 65.3 cents spent per dollar

-$5.9B

Alphabet's free cash flow, second quarter of 2026

Alphabet release, Jul 22, 2026: $39.1B of operating cash against $44.9B of purchases

WHO IS ON EACH SIDE

Is AI revenue arriving fast enough for the biggest spenders to pay for their data centers out of their own cash?

Each voice is attributed and paraphrased, dated where the date is known, with a link where one exists. DeepStack shows no score, ranking or accuracy for any person. The page: `deepstack.ltd/sides/the-cash-arrives-unevenly/`

13 VOICES

The cash still covers it

Market Sentiment Sep 17, 2026

Based on their capex sustainability model, Market Sentiment estimates that next year's ~$1.2T+ of AI capex should drive ~$2T of incremental revenue, which they say will only be a fraction of the total incremental revenue AI generates as a business...

`www.marketsentiment.co/p/the-next-great-ai-trade-is-everything`

Market Sentiment Aug 8, 2026

Modeled bottom-up, 100 billion dollars of annual data-center capex sustains roughly 160 billion of steady-state annual revenue, a 1.6x revenue-to-capex multiple and about a 21 percent IRR, even assuming a five-year chip life and a one-third annual...

`www.marketsentiment.co/p/is-the-capex-sustainable`

Ren Oct 5, 2026

A cracking labor market is a real risk for anything tied to the consumer, and the AI buildout being funded by hyperscaler cash flows and multi-year contracts is why, for now, it stays on the watchlist and doesn't change the thesis.

`renstocks.substack.com/p/early-october-portfolio-update-the`

Ren Oct 6, 2026

Because every cloud and hardware dollar traces back to someone paying for AI at the top, the application and model boxes are the demand test for the whole map; in 2030 the stack would spend $3-4T a year on hardware while apps and models bring in…

renstocks.substack.com/p/the-ai-stack-by-2030

Harley Bassman Sep 17, 2026

Anthropic itself is not borrowing the money; it is the hyperscalers (he names Meta, Google, Amazon, Microsoft, Oracle) who are borrowing to use Anthropic's products, so if Anthropic were to go bust, that would be an equity problem rather than a…

Aurelion Research Sep 11, 2026

Hyperscaler capex is durable rather than at risk of a sudden cut, because the largest spenders keep reaffirming the necessity of AI investment and their EBITDA and EBIT margins are still rising, giving them capacity to keep funding it.

read.aurelionresearch.com/p/in-conversation-nvidia

Aurelion Research Aug 21, 2026

Hyperscaler capex has come in more than 56% above what the market was forecasting a year ago, with spending estimates continuing to be revised upward without signs of slowing.

Invest in Assets Aug 11, 2026

Citing management's account of two distinct capital cycles, roughly two years of data center construction before any revenue against 30-plus years of monetization, and about three years to break even on servers with a five to six year life, Invest…

www.investinassets.net/p/why-im-bullish-on-amazon

Invest in Assets Aug 11, 2026

Amazon expects roughly $220 billion in cash CapEx in 2026, up from an earlier $200 billion estimate, driven primarily by higher memory chip costs.

www.investinassets.net/p/why-im-bullish-on-amazon

Kakashii Sep 24, 2026

Because Oracle could not keep funding the AI buildout on its own without loading hundreds of billions in debt that could endanger the company once the AI boom cools, Oracle shifted to a 'saving move' in which customers either bring their own GPUs…

Kakashii Sep 24, 2026

Kakashii estimates that after excluding roughly 200B of legacy and non-AI RPO (including ByteDance's U.S. datacenter deal), Oracle's remaining RPO of 464B is attributable to AI Compute Cloud, of which close to 300B-350B is attributed to OpenAI…

Tae Kim Oct 2, 2026

Axios reported, and the Financial Times later confirmed the same day, that OpenAI's annual recurring revenue is nearing $70 billion, with enterprise sales more than doubled since July according to sources familiar with the financials.

taekim.substack.com/p/openais-undeniable-resurgence-and

Tae Kim Oct 2, 2026

Tae Kim believes that if OpenAI were public, its stock would have gapped up 30% or more on hitting $70 billion in ARR, a blowout versus expectations on the level of Nvidia in May 2023, and that the figure proves his August report that OpenAI's ARR...

taekim.substack.com/p/openais-undeniable-resurgence-and

THE STRONGEST CASE AGAINST THIS SIDE

Torsten Slok Sep 29, 2026

Analysts covering tech expect the sector's operating cash flow to more than double to roughly $2.4 trillion by 2028, an increase of over $1.2 trillion, while analysts covering the other S&P 500 sectors, which are tech's customers, expect those...

Contradicts Market Sentiment on evidence · www.apollo.com/insights-news/insights/daily-spark/tech-trillion-dollar-internal-inconsistency

13 VOICES

The bill has moved to debt

Hayden Capital Aug 27, 2026

The current hyperscaler capex boom, with Alphabet, Amazon, Meta, and Microsoft together spending close to $800 billion in 2026, requires external capital funding for the first time because capex now exceeds internal cash flow.

fiscal.ai/fund-letters/hayden-capital-q2-2026-fscl_document_4UXZ6MTS260

Hayden Capital Aug 27, 2026

The sustainability and predictability of incremental returns on invested capital in hyperscaler AI projects matters more to valuations than the absolute level of those returns, because the market values certainty.

fiscal.ai/fund-letters/hayden-capital-q2-2026-fscl_document_4UXZ6MTS260

Dylan Patel Aug 25, 2026

Hyperscalers including Google, Microsoft, Amazon and Meta funded more than half of compute growth so far but now do not generate cash, spending everything on CapEx and raising debt on top, so for a roughly $3 or $4 trillion 2028 CapEx level the...

Dylan Patel Aug 25, 2026

Headline AI CapEx figures of $40-50 billion cover only critical IT such as servers, networking, fiber, transceivers and optics, not the data center shells or power plants, which must be built ahead of time, so a 100-gigawatt-a-year build is much...

Ed Elson Aug 11, 2026

Google spent $45 billion and Amazon $54 billion on capital expenditures in a single quarter, and both ended up with negative cash flows despite huge cash intake.

www.profgmedia.com/p/plastic-surgery

Guinness Global Investors Aug 1, 2026

The AI investment cycle is entering a new phase focused on economic returns rather than just capital expenditure.

Guinness Global Investors Aug 1, 2026

Meta is moving toward the upper end of its $130-145bn capex range, fueling broader market concerns about negative free cash flow and the lack of clear returns on massive AI investments.

Michael Burry Sep 19, 2026

Across the five hyperscalers, uncommenced, non-cancelable data-center leases and purchase commitments together total roughly $2.7 trillion in off-balance-sheet contractual commitments as of the disclosed filing dates, with the total potentially...

michaeljburry.substack.com/p/the-heretics-guide-to-ais-stars-part-c9c

Michael Burry Sep 19, 2026

Most analysts covering the former software/social-media/AdTech companies now recast as hyperscalers have never had to model maintenance capital expenditure, and most still are not doing it, or not doing it well.

michaeljburry.substack.com/p/the-heretics-guide-to-ais-stars-part-c9c

JunkBondInvestor Aug 9, 2026

Hyperscaler capex for 2027 tracks as high as 1.2 trillion dollars with about 400 billion of debt issuance penciled for next year; AI-related paper doubled from about 3 percent to 6 percent of the investment-grade index in a year, Amazon became the...

www.junkbondinvestor.com/p/credit-weekly-what-if-they-just-keep

JunkBondInvestor Sep 13, 2026

A $5 billion Pentagon loan to an $18 billion company signals that government is done leaving the pace of AI investment to private hurdle rates, and while private capital keeps working, it is now being joined by capital priced to different...

Michael Spencer Sep 29, 2026

Given the cost for compute, Meta's free cash flow is going to crater in 2027 to a very suspect degree, and like Oracle, betting on a product tied to accelerating compute demand at any cost is borderline insane to Michael Spencer.

www.ai-supremacy.com/p/the-era-of-personal-super-intelligent-agents-muse-2026

Michael Spencer Oct 9, 2026

A Financial Times report found OpenAI's annualized revenue as of late September 2026 was approximately $50 billion, roughly $20 billion lower than the $70 billion figure that had previously circulated in financial media.

www.ai-supremacy.com/p/ai-off-the-charts-ii-state-of-ai-2026-chart-summary

THE STRONGEST CASE AGAINST THIS SIDE

Torsten Slok Sep 21, 2026

Consensus expects hyperscalers' operating cash flow to more than triple by 2030, outpacing the sharp increase in AI-driven capex, based on FactSet and Apollo Chief Economist sources for Google, Meta, Amazon, Microsoft and Oracle.

Contradicts Michael Burry on evidence · www.apollo.com/insights-news/insights/daily-spark/hyperscaler-credit-rests-on-one-consensus-assumption

14 VOICES

The buyers have not paid yet

Torsten Slok Sep 29, 2026

Analysts covering tech expect the sector's operating cash flow to more than double to roughly $2.4 trillion by 2028, an increase of over $1.2 trillion, while analysts covering the other S&P 500 sectors, which are tech's customers, expect those...

www.apollo.com/insights-news/insights/daily-spark/tech-trillion-dollar-internal-inconsistency

Torsten Slok Sep 21, 2026

Consensus expects hyperscalers' operating cash flow to more than triple by 2030, outpacing the sharp increase in AI-driven capex, based on FactSet and Apollo Chief Economist sources for Google, Meta, Amazon, Microsoft and Oracle.

www.apollo.com/insights-news/insights/daily-spark/hyperscaler-credit-rests-on-one-consensus-assumption

Daniel Romero Sep 21, 2026

Daniel Romero states they are not arguing the buildout is unsustainable, but that one-year compute paybacks will probably become the exception rather than a baseline assumption, possibly dependent on specific timing and shortages, and that 2026...

hypertechinvest.com/p/the-math-behind-the-next-ai-rally

Daniel Romero Sep 21, 2026

Although SpaceX reports AI infrastructure payback periods of less than one year, maintaining a one-year payback across the entire hypothetical 2027 buildout would require $1.9-2.28 trillion in annual compute payments, and if AI labs footed that...

hypertechinvest.com/p/the-math-behind-the-next-ai-rally

Nathaniel Whittemore Oct 9, 2026

OpenAI told investors it hit roughly $50 billion in annualized revenue at the end of September, a fairly large gap from the $68 billion figure widely reported the prior month.

Nathaniel Whittemore Oct 9, 2026

OpenAI also told investors it achieved 77% run-rate growth in the third quarter and 107% growth in its enterprise business, but even that growth was completely overshadowed by the $20 billion gap in revenue, with Wall Street reacting in many ways...

Steve Eisman Sep 21, 2026

The AI trade's foundations are shaky because roughly seventy percent of the hyperscalers' AI revenue traces back to just two customers, OpenAI and Anthropic, both of which are burning enormous amounts of cash, so if either stumbles the entire...

realeismanplaybook.substack.com/p/stock-picking-in-difficult-times

Steve Eisman Sep 21, 2026

George Noble's bear case for AI rests on the question of actual return on investment; he argues that Nvidia announcing massive funding packages just to keep customers like OpenAI able to keep buying chips shows the money underneath the boom is not...

realeismanplaybook.substack.com/p/stock-picking-in-difficult-times

First Pacific Advisors Aug 17, 2026

They are uncertain about the sustainability of the current and projected level of AI capital spending and the prospect of it generating reasonable returns on the aggregate investment.

First Pacific Advisors Jul 30, 2026

Global AI spending is projected to reach 2.59 trillion dollars in 2026, and to achieve even a relatively low unlevered return on investment would require 207 billion dollars in after-tax income per year starting immediately, which the portfolio…

Longriver Jul 20, 2026

He states it is equally possible that AI transforms business and society yet fails to earn an adequate return for the companies that built it, since revenue can arrive well before owner earnings if depreciation understates obsolescence or…

`fiscal.ai/fund-letters/longriver-investment-partners-limited-q2-2026-fscl_document_8HDF9YVG683`

Longriver Jul 20, 2026

AI capex has become a prisoner's dilemma financed increasingly by leases, purchase commitments, debt and in one case an equity raise: each firm may invest rationally to protect existing businesses while the industry collectively commits too much…

`fiscal.ai/fund-letters/longriver-investment-partners-limited-q2-2026-fscl_document_8HDF9YVG683`

Bronte Capital

They say it remains uncertain to them how likely it is that AI spending dramatically slows as Wall Street and the AI funders realise they cannot get a return.

Bronte Capital

They conclude either the AI companies will not earn a return on the trillions they are spending, or they will earn it at the cost of very large short-term unemployment, or most likely a combination of both.

THE STRONGEST CASE AGAINST THIS SIDE

Michael Spencer Sep 29, 2026

Given the cost for compute, Meta's free cash flow is going to crater in 2027 to a very suspect degree, and like Oracle, betting on a product tied to accelerating compute demand at any cost is borderline insane to Michael Spencer.

Contradicts Torsten Slok on evidence · `www.ai-supremacy.com/p/the-era-of-personal-super-intelligent-agents-muse-2026`

8 VOICES

Voices that cross sides

Ren Oct 6, 2026

That gap can hold for a while because hyperscalers fund capex from non-AI businesses, debt covers part of it and hardware is paid off over several years, but eventually it has to close from the top, and if the $2.1T arrives late every floor…

`renstocks.substack.com/p/the-ai-stack-by-2030`

Ren Sep 15, 2026

AGI is not the investable trade; compute is, because Astra adds a second, inference-driven demand chain (more capable models, more agents, more delegated work, longer inference trajectories, more tokens, more compute) alongside the existing…

Torsten Slok Sep 12, 2026

In the data center buildout, hyperscalers have been able to raise all the capital they have asked for, but they are paying more for it: spreads on their longest-dated bonds have widened, and most 2026-issued paper trades wider today than where it…

www.apollo.com/insights-news/insights/daily-spark/from-a-savings-glut-to-a-savings-shortage

Torsten Slok Sep 21, 2026

The credit story for hyperscalers depends on a single consensus assumption that operating cash flow triples from $600 billion to $2 trillion.

www.apollo.com/insights-news/insights/daily-spark/hyperscaler-credit-rests-on-one-consensus-assumption

Oguz Erkan Aug 23, 2026

Oguz Erkan does not regard the AI capex fear as valid for this cycle: capex went from $28 billion in 2023 to $72 billion last year and is expected at $130-$145 billion this year and $202 billion by 2030, but committed capital is already earning ROI…

Oguz Erkan Aug 6, 2026

The loop's binding constraint is capex finance: hyperscaler free cash flow may go negative in 2027 and investors dislike leverage contingent on speculative returns, as the depressed valuations of Oracle and CoreWeave show, so continued spending…

Dylan Patel Aug 25, 2026

Labs have not yet reached the point where their own cash flows can fund the scale of CapEx required, since labs are projected to generate hundreds of billions in revenue next year while total CapEx across the compute supply chain will be well north…

Dylan Patel Aug 25, 2026

His current modeling has $5 trillion of credit-funded and $6 trillion of cash-funded infrastructure investment through 2029, and this is not enough compute relative to projected AI demand growth, so revenue per megawatt has to keep rising.

NOT A DISAGREEMENT

The thread

Part 4 said the bill had arrived; Part 8, that the cash must triple. Part 14 reads, company by company, who still pays in cash.

WHERE THEY CROSS

The specific points where one voice meets another: the same evidence read two ways, or the same mechanism with a different sign.

Ren qualifies Michael Spencer on mechanism

Guinness Global Investors qualifies Torsten Slok on evidence

Guinness Global Investors contradicts Torsten Slok on premise

Michael Spencer qualifies Torsten Slok on mechanism

Torsten Slok qualifies Hayden Capital on mechanism

Steve Eisman contradicts Michael Burry on mechanism

Torsten Slok qualifies Longriver on mechanism

Michael Spencer qualifies Ren on condition

Ren contradicts Nathaniel Whittemore on premise

Michael Spencer contradicts Steve Eisman on mechanism

Torsten Slok qualifies First Pacific Advisors on evidence

Michael Burry qualifies JunkBondInvestor on mechanism

Michael Spencer qualifies Ren on evidence

Bronte Capital qualifies Kakashii on condition

Michael Spencer qualifies Ren on mechanism

Michael Burry refutes Steve Eisman on mechanism

Bronte Capital qualifies JunkBondInvestor on condition

Torsten Slok qualifies Steve Eisman on evidence

Torsten Slok qualifies Hayden Capital on condition

Torsten Slok qualifies Market Sentiment on condition

Bronte Capital qualifies Market Sentiment on condition

Hayden Capital qualifies Michael Spencer on mechanism

Guinness Global Investors qualifies Invest in Assets on mechanism

Aurelion Research refutes Michael Burry on evidence

THE DATED TESTS

What would settle it, on the Docket. A test is specified when an outsider can settle it without asking anyone: the question, the source, the rule and what happens if the source is late, revised or silent.

Oct 28, 2026 p14-t01 PENDING

Alphabet's September quarter: whether capital spending takes 80 cents or more of each dollar of operating cash, after 49.5 cents a year earlier and 95.0 cents in the first half of 2026.

Question	Did Alphabet's purchases of property and equipment for the quarter ended September 30, 2026 equal 80% or more of its net cash provided by operating activities for the same quarter?
Source	SEC EDGAR, Alphabet filings (the earnings release on Form 8-K and the Form 10-Q for the quarter), CIK 0001652044 `www.sec.gov/cgi-bin/browse-edgar?action=getcompany&CIK=0001652044`
Rule	Take the three-month figures from the statement of cash flows in Alphabet's earnings release; if the release gives only year-to-date figures, use the nine-month figure less the six-month figure from the Form 10-Q. Divide purchases of property and equipment by net cash provided by operating activities. The answer is yes if the ratio is 80.0% or more; no if it is below 80.0%. Alphabet's own free cash flow line, finance leases and its spending guidance for the year are read alongside and do not decide the test.
If the source is late, revised or silent	Alphabet has scheduled the release for October 28, 2026. If neither the release nor a Form 10-Q states the quarter's cash flow figures on EDGAR by November 9, 2026, the test is inconclusive, and the Result says what was read and what was missing; the next reading is November 16, 2026. Figures are read as first filed; a later amendment does not reopen the test.

Nov 10, 2026 p14-t02 PENDING

The four's September-quarter reports on EDGAR: whether combined purchases of property and equipment topped combined operating cash, after 96.1% in the June quarter of 2026.

Question	Did the combined purchases of property and equipment of Microsoft, Alphabet, Amazon and Meta for the quarter ended September 30, 2026 exceed their combined net cash provided by operating activities for the same quarter?
Source	SEC EDGAR, the Forms 10-Q of Microsoft, Alphabet, Amazon and Meta for the quarter (statements of cash flows; XBRL company facts) `www.sec.gov/edgar/search/`
Rule	Read each company's statement of cash flows for the quarter; where a Form 10-Q gives only year-to-date figures, the quarter is the later cumulative figure less the earlier one from the same fiscal year (for Microsoft, the first quarter of its fiscal 2027). For Amazon, purchases are the gross line, before proceeds from sales and incentives. Sum the four purchases and the four operating figures. The answer is yes if combined purchases exceed combined net cash provided by operating activities; no if they are equal or lower. Each company's own ratio and free cash flow measure are read alongside and do not decide the test.
If the source is late, revised or silent	If any of the four Forms 10-Q is not on EDGAR by November 9, 2026, the filing deadline for large companies, the test is inconclusive on November 10, and the Result says what was read and what was missing; the next reading is November 16, 2026. Figures are read as first filed; a restated earlier quarter in the same filings is named in the Result and does not change the reading.

Feb 12, 2027 p14-t03 PENDING

The 2027 budgets of Alphabet, Amazon and Meta: whether the midpoints sum to at least 25% more than the three spent in 2026.

Question	Do the midpoints of the 2027 capital expenditure guidance that Alphabet, Amazon and Meta give with their fourth-quarter 2026 results sum to at least 25% more than the three companies' 2026 capital expenditures?
Source	Investor-relations pages of Alphabet (abc.xyz/investor), Amazon (ir.aboutamazon.com) and Meta (investor.atmeta.com): fourth-quarter 2026 earnings releases and call transcripts `abc.xyz/investor/`
Rule	Each company's 2026 capital expenditures and its 2027 guidance are read as that company defines capital expenditures in the release or on the call that gives the guidance (for Meta, including principal payments on finance leases). A range counts at its midpoint; a single figure counts as given; a floor stated as at least or more than a figure counts at that figure. The answer is yes if the three 2027 figures sum to 1.25 times the three 2026 figures or more; no if the sum is below that. Microsoft gives no calendar-year figure and is not part of the test.
If the source is late, revised or silent	If any of the three gives no 2027 figure by February 12, 2027, the test is inconclusive, and the Result says what was read and what was missing; the next reading is that company's first-quarter 2027 results, by May 15, 2027. Guidance revised after the first statement does not reopen the test.

Feb 16, 2027 p14-t04 PENDING

The full year: whether the four's purchases topped their operating cash across calendar 2026, after 91.4% in the first half.

Question	Did the combined purchases of property and equipment of Microsoft, Alphabet, Amazon and Meta for the four calendar quarters of 2026 exceed their combined net cash provided by operating activities for the same quarters?
Source	SEC EDGAR, the 2026 annual reports (Form 10-K) of Alphabet, Amazon and Meta and Microsoft's Forms 10-K and 10-Q covering January to December 2026 (statements of cash flows; XBRL company facts) `www.sec.gov/edgar/search/`
Rule	Sum, for each company, January 1 to December 31, 2026: Alphabet, Amazon and Meta from their annual statements of cash flows; Microsoft from the four quarters of its fiscal 2026 and 2027 that fall in the calendar year, each the later cumulative figure less the earlier one. For Amazon, purchases are the gross line, before proceeds from sales and incentives. The answer is yes if combined purchases exceed combined net cash provided by operating activities; no if they are equal or lower. Each company's own free cash flow measure is read alongside and does not decide the test.
If the source is late, revised or silent	If any of the filings is not on EDGAR on February 16, 2027, the reading waits; if one is still missing on March 1, 2027, the annual-report deadline for large companies, the test is inconclusive, and the Result says what was read and what was missing; the next reading is March 15, 2027. Figures are read as first filed; a restated quarter is named in the Result and does not change the reading.

THE TEST CAME IN

No test from this Part has resolved yet. Results are promoted by a person and listed on the Results page.

SOURCES AND FURTHER READING

1. Market Sentiment - Is the capex sustainable? · `www.marketsentiment.co/p/is-the-capex-sustainable`
2. Hayden Capital - Q2 2026 letter · `fiscal.ai/fund-letters/hayden-capital-q2-2026-fscl_document_4UXZ6MTS260`
3. U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission - EDGAR XBRL company data · `www.sec.gov/search-filings/edgar-application-programming-interfaces`

4. Alphabet - Second quarter 2026 results (Form 8-K, Exhibit 99.1) · www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1652044/000165204426000066/googexhibit991q22026.htm
5. Amazon - Second quarter 2026 results · www.aboutamazon.com/news/company-news/amazon-earnings-q2-2026-report
6. Microsoft - Fourth quarter fiscal 2026 results · news.microsoft.com/source/2026/07/29/microsoft-cloud-and-ai-strength-fuels-fourth-quarter-results-4/
7. Aurelion Research - In Conversation: NVIDIA · read.aurelionresearch.com/p/in-conversation-nvidia
8. Oguz Erkan, Capitalist Letters - META Deep Dive: Opportunity or a Trap? · www.capitalist-letters.com/p/meta-deep-dive-opportunity-or-a-trap
9. Invest In Assets - Factsheet July 2026 · www.investinassets.net/p/factsheet-july-2026
10. Invest In Assets - Why I'm Bullish on Amazon · www.investinassets.net/p/why-im-bullish-on-amazon
11. Ed Elson, Prof G Markets - Plastic Surgery · www.profgmedia.com/p/plastic-surgery
12. Meta - Second quarter 2026 results · www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/meta-reports-second-quarter-2026-results-302838214.html
13. JunkBondInvestor - Credit Weekly: What If They Just Keep Borrowing? · www.junkbondinvestor.com/p/credit-weekly-what-if-they-just-keep
14. Torsten Slok, Apollo - From a Savings Glut to a Savings Shortage · www.apollo.com/insights-news/insights/daily-spark/from-a-savings-glut-to-a-savings-shortage
15. Torsten Slok, Apollo - Tech's Trillion-Dollar Internal Inconsistency · www.apollo.com/insights-news/insights/daily-spark/tech-trillion-dollar-internal-inconsistency
16. Torsten Slok, Apollo - Hyperscaler Credit Rests on One Consensus Assumption · www.apollo.com/insights-news/insights/daily-spark/hyperscaler-credit-rests-on-one-consensus-assumption
17. Market Sentiment - The next great AI trade is everything that isn't AI · www.marketsentiment.co/p/the-next-great-ai-trade-is-everything
18. Daniel Romero, HyperTech Invest - The Math Behind the Next AI Rally · hypertechinvest.com/p/the-math-behind-the-next-ai-rally
19. Michael Spencer, AI Supremacy - AI off the Charts II · www.ai-supremacy.com/p/ai-off-the-charts-ii-state-of-ai-2026-chart-summary
20. Longriver Investment Partners - Q2 2026 letter · fiscal.ai/fund-letters/longriver-investment-partners-limited-q2-2026-fscl_document_8HDF9YVG683
21. First Pacific Advisors - Q2 2026 letter · fiscal.ai/fund-letters/first-pacific-advisors-lp-q2-2026-fscl_document_9KDV3DNH810
22. Kingswell - The Berkshire Beat: July 24, 2026 · www.kingswell.io/p/the-berkshire-beat-july-24-2026
23. Oguz Erkan, Capitalist Letters - It's Time To Be Bullish On Compute, Again · www.capitalist-letters.com/p/its-time-to-be-bullish-on-compute
24. Alphabet - Date of third quarter 2026 results · abc.xyz/investor/news/news-details/2026/Alphabet-Announces-Date-of-Third-Quarter-2026-Financial-Results-Conference-Call-2026-8tpGZsLS6v/default.aspx
25. Microsoft - Quarterly earnings release date · news.microsoft.com/source/2026/10/07/microsoft-announces-quarterly-earnings-release-date-69/

How DeepStack settles a question

Every Part of The Buildout asks one question and gathers the strongest case on each side from named investors and analysts, attributed, dated and linked. DeepStack then takes a side in The DeepStack Call, names what it would take to change its mind, and sets dated tests that an outsider can read on the day. When a test comes in, the result is published with its evidence, confirmed, refuted or inconclusive, and the Call's history records when the house changed its mind and why. No person is scored or ranked. No accuracy rate is shown until ten results exist.

Quoted passages are short, attributed by name and linked to their source; the paraphrases are DeepStack's. Quote this memo with attribution and a link to the canonical page.

This memo reflects the page as of October 21, 2026. Canonical page: https://deepstack.ltd/stories/the-cash-arrives-unevenly/. Who is on each side: https://deepstack.ltd/sides/the-cash-arrives-unevenly/.

Analysis and opinion, not investment advice.